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March 1, 2026

THE MONTHLY NEWSLETTER FOR RESIDENTS OF THE MPII CDD

MPII NEWS



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Meadow Pointe II Clubhouse

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Facebook.com/MPIICDD

Operations Manager

Justin Wright
justinwright@mpiicdd.org

Office Hours

Daily 8am—8:45pm

Fitness Center

M-F 7am—8:45pm
S/S 8am—8:45pm

Pool

Daily 9am—30 minutes before dusk

Playground

Daily 9am—30 minutes before dusk

Courts

Daily 8am—8:45pm



A Great Blue Heron patiently watches the water of one of MPII's 100+ ponds. Our community ponds are ideal for these Herons—one of the many majestic large birds common in our area. Strong Heron populations are often indicators of wetland health. Hopefully the drought doesn't hinder their numbers. *Photo courtesy of Jim Budinoff.*

MPII CDD Board of Supervisors

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The CDD Board of Supervisors holds public meetings twice each month. These are held on the 1st and 3rd Wednesdays at 6:30 pm in the Clubhouse.

All MPII residents are welcomed and encouraged to attend. This is your CDD and attending meetings is the best way to stay informed and share your input.

The Future of *MPII News*

After the last 10+ years, the District (MPII) has decided that we will begin to phase out the print version of the newsletter. What does this mean to you, dear reader?

First, the good news. The Clubhouse staff will continue to write and produce *MPII News* for as long as there is value in it for the Clubhouse, the CDD Board, and the residents. It is *still* a great communication tool that helps make living in MPII feel like our home community. Also, this will be a drawn-out process, so everyone has time to adjust. And importantly, our residents that are unable, or undesiring, of utilizing online options will STILL be able to get a print version for a long time to come.

Phase one will be this issue of *MPII News* as well as the next two issues over the coming months. This issue, as well as the April 1st and May 1st issues will come out exactly as they have for the last decade. In these months, hopefully most or all residents will become aware of the coming changes and can prepare. Many residents may opt-in by emailing newsletter@mpiicdd.org their email address to receive the PDF directly in their email.

Alternatively, residents can email us, call the Clubhouse, or stop by the Clubhouse to request they continue to receive the print version in the mail. Residents who do not request this will not receive a print copy after May 1st. Another option will be for residents to come to the Clubhouse to pick up a print version of the newsletter after the 1st of each month.

Phase two will begin June 1st, where most residents will access *MPII News* electronically. Either by receiving the PDF via email or reading the posted PDF on our website. If you opted to receive a mailed copy, it would continue to be mailed to you. Phase two will likely last a long time. Phase three will be when we cease producing a physical version at all. There is NO DATE set for this part, it may well be years away.

Making these changes will save a lot of money that can benefit all MPII residents in other ways. It will also be an eco-friendly change, reducing the amount of paper and ink used to produce over 2,000 copies of our newsletter each month.

So, please use the next couple of months to either opt-in on the mailing list for PDF distribution, or familiarize yourself with the MPII website so you'll be able to find the newsletter in the future, or contact the Clubhouse about continuing to receive a print version. However you choose to receive *MPII News*, we hope you will keep reading and keep helping make MPII a wonderful community and a great place to live.

Gardening Tips

With the wild weather and extensive cold spells we have had in the Bay area in January and February, March is the perfect time to get your garden and landscape in recovery mode and hopefully in shape for the upcoming growing season. Before the weather really heats up in April, gardeners can take advantage of this window to prepare for spring blooms and enhance outdoor spaces. Here are some key tips to help your garden thrive this month.

March is a great time to prune many shrubs, especially those that bloom in spring and summer. Shrubs like hibiscus, bougainvillea, and lantana can be trimmed back to encourage fresh growth. Be sure to remove any dead or damaged wood and give your plants a tidy shape. For flowering shrubs, wait until after they have finished blooming to avoid cutting off next season's flowers.

As Central Florida moves towards the warmer months, it's important to start thinking about lawn care. Apply a balanced, slow-release fertilizer to your turfgrass in early March. This helps to give your lawn a healthy boost as it begins to wake up from its winter dormancy. If you have St. Augustine or Zoysia grass, now is the time to give it the nutrients it needs to remain green and strong as the weather warms.

Mulching your garden beds now will help retain moisture and regulate soil temperature as the weather fluctuates. A layer of organic mulch, like pine bark or cypress mulch, will also help to suppress weeds. This simple step can make a big difference in keeping your garden healthy as the heat of summer approaches.

Now is also the perfect time to plant spring-blooming flowers like pansies, petunias, and snapdragons. These annuals will add color to your landscape, even as the weather remains cool. For perennials, it's also a good time to divide and replant those that have outgrown their space. Keep an eye on your local garden center for early-blooming bulbs like lilies and irises.

While Central Florida's temperatures typically warm up but remain mild in March, rainfall can be unpredictable. Continue to monitor the moisture level in your garden, especially for newly planted beds or containers. We've endured a lengthy dry period this past winter, so be sure to water deeply to encourage deep root growth. Early morning watering is best to minimize evaporation and prevent fungal growth. However, please stick to your designated watering days as...

Gardening Tips continues on page 6...

March MPII Trivia

Trivia – What was St. Patrick's name at birth?

Answer on page 7.

MPII Management Company

Inframark
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CDD fee/Bond Questions

Inframark Accounting Department
assessments@inframark.com

The MPII Clubhouse offers MPII residents Notary Services at no cost.

We have a certified Notary on staff, please call ahead for availability.

Focus on Wellness

In addition to March being Women's History Month, March is also National Nutrition Month, but the week of the 8th – 14th is Sleep Awareness Week, and the 20th is International Day of Happiness. Combined with the fact that statistically, 67 – 80% of Americans have now abandoned their New Year's resolutions, we thought that March made a great time to encourage all MPII residents to focus on their wellness.

Our community is at its best – its strongest – when all of us individually are at *our* best and *our* strongest – physically and mentally. Use this month to start making small changes that can add up to having a big impact on your overall wellness. Don't make changes you can't continue with long-term. Start small. Perhaps simply increase your veggie, protein, or fiber intake. Perhaps consult with a professional nutritionist/dietician.

Perhaps focus on exercise. Move a little more a couple times per week. Add a short walk or bike ride. Or wear a weighted vest when you tackle household chores or tasks. It doesn't have to be three hours in a gym every day. You can see and *feel* the impact of small, incremental changes.

Alternately, or in addition, focus on your mental and emotional well-being. Take short breaks. Consider trying meditation. Set aside time to socialize with friends and loved ones. Importantly, focus on being able to offer help to the people in your life, AND being able to ask for help when you need it. Don't forget to set aside time for yourself – read a book, do a crossword puzzle, play a video game, whatever takes you away from the normal stresses for a few minutes.

Perhaps most importantly, focus on your sleep. Countless studies have shown that a regular sleep schedule, combined with getting enough sleep each night, is one of the best things we can do for our health – physical and mental.

For most people, making small, sustainable changes can have a major impact on your life. And the happier and healthier we all are, the easier it is to be a better neighbor, community member, mom, dad, brother, sister, friend, spouse… human. So, use March, start now. Focus on your personal wellness a little bit at a time. Then, enjoy the results.

March is Women's History Month



In honor of Women's History Month, we're choosing to honor a woman who was a trailblazer in math and science – Gladys Brown West. She contributed to the mathematical modeling of Earth, and her work was incorporated into GPS systems used today. She passed away in January at the age of 95. You can learn more about her at the sites below.

"I made a commitment to be the best I could be and absorb as much knowledge that a little farm girl could handle." – Gladys Brown West

- https://ncwit.org/profile/gladys-west/
- https://www.war.gov/News/Feature-Stories/Story/article/3700859/navy-scientist-helped-develop-gps/

March Holidays



4th – Holi. Holi starts at sundown on the 3rd and goes through to sundown on the 4th. Also known as the festival of color or the festival of love, Holi is a very joyous Hindu festival commemorating the victory of good over evil and the end of winter for spring. To all our residents who celebrate: Happy Holi!



8th – Daylight Saving Time. Officially beginning at 2 am, we will be on Daylight Saving Time. So, on Saturday night before bed, set all your clocks and watches forward one hour. Hopefully we all won't miss that lost hour of sleep too much!



15th – Laylat al-Qadr. Laylat al-Qadr, or the Night of Power, is part of the end of Ramadan. It is the celebration of the first verses of the Quran being revealed to Muhammad. For all those that celebrate, have a happy and blessed Laylat al-Qadr!



17th – St. Patrick's Day. Today is St. Patrick's Day, originally a Christian holiday commemorating St. Patrick, who is credited with spreading Christianity through Ireland. Today, it has evolved into a cultural holiday as well, celebrated by everyone, whether Christian, Irish, or not. So wear your green, head to the River O'Green event downtown on 3/14 and don't miss this year's parade that same night (3/14)! Most importantly, have a Happy St. Patrick's Day!



20th – Eid al-Fitr. This is the day where Muslims celebrate the end of Ramadan and its fasting. It occurs tonight at sundown (depending on the moon phase). To all those that celebrate: Eid Mubarak! (Have a blessed Eid).



21st – Spring/Ostara. Today spring begins. Today (and again at the autumnal equinox), the periods of daylight and night are as close to perfectly equal as they will be all year. This day has been celebrated as the end of winter/start of spring or a time of rebirth for many thousands of years. Happy Spring! Ostara is a pagan holiday starting at the equinox and going through the next full day (3/22) that celebrates light and dark being in balance, and the new beginning or rebirth that comes with Spring.



29th – Palm Sunday. Palm Sunday is a Christian holiday commemorating Jesus' entry into Jerusalem. For those that celebrate: Happy Palm Sunday!



Gardening Tips

Continued from page 3

established by Pasco County.

Even though the cooler weather this winter limited the activity of some pests, it's still important to check your plants for early signs of insect activity and disease now that we're warming back up. Look for aphids, spider mites, and whiteflies, and treat them promptly with eco-friendly insecticidal soap or neem oil. Prevent fungal diseases by ensuring your plants have adequate air circulation and are not overcrowded.

Now is the time to plan and begin spring landscaping projects. Whether you're thinking of installing a new flower bed, adding a water feature, or expanding your patio, March's mild weather is perfect for getting a head start. You can also begin working on your irrigation system to ensure your plants will thrive during the hotter months.

Ensure that the trees and palms in your landscape are in good shape after the cooler than usual winter we've had. Prune dead or damaged fronds from palms and check for any limbs that might pose a hazard during storms. If you have fruit trees, inspect them for signs of disease or pests and remove any weak or crossing branches.

By staying proactive with these gardening and landscaping tips, March will set the stage for a vibrant and thriving outdoor space throughout the year. As the temperatures begin to rise in Central Florida, you'll be well-prepared to enjoy the beauty and bounty of your hard work come spring! Happy gardening!

- Prune and Shape Shrubs
- Fertilize Lawns
- Mulch Garden Beds
- Prepare for Spring Flowers
- Water Wisely
- Inspect for Pests and Disease
- Prepare for Spring Landscaping Projects

Check Trees and Palms

Community Garage Sale

The MPII Spring Community Garage Sale is right around the corner! MPII will be doing it on Saturday, April 11th, from 8am – 2pm. This is one of only two opportunities per year when the village gates will be held open. This sale is a fantastic way to clear some clutter and make a little extra cash while doing it. Also, Goodwill will have a truck at the Clubhouse parking lot for unsold items you'd like to donate from 10 am until it's full. Here are a few tips you can start working on now to be ready on 4/11:

- Organize and prepare – in the weeks leading up, gather your "inventory" and place it together.
- Price as many items as possible – use stickers, tape, tags – something. Pricing helps!
- Haggle! Many garage sale customers haggle. Remember your goal is to purge.
- Involve the kids! – A sale is a great opportunity to get rid of their old stuff too. Let them have some of the money for their items and put them to work.
- Bundle – Retailers do it, you should too. Put things together and price them as a group. You can always split them up later if necessary.
- Clean a little – No one wants to buy dirty, dusty, old things. Wipe everything down and clean things up a little before they go on display for sale.
- Have change ready – Small bills and quarters are especially helpful.
- Have a lot out! – If you don't have a lot, partner up with a neighbor or two and display together. Browsers often drive slowly through a village but only stop for "bigger" sales.

Upcoming MPII EPC Events

The EPC's first event of 2026 was last month's free shredding event. Lock Tight Shredding brought their mobile shredding truck to the MPII Clubhouse parking lot and lots of MPII residents were able to safely destroy and get rid of papers with personal data and information, all for free. This was the second such event the MPII EPC has done, hopefully we will be able to have this event on a recurring basis since it's such a great opportunity for residents to prevent identity theft and other issues.

The next EPC event is also a staple – we're doing another Great American Cleanup! On Saturday, March 7th, the EPC is hoping that residents will come out to pick up litter and debris along our main roads in MPII. This is a fantastic opportunity for students wanting to pick up volunteer hours for scholarships, and it's something whole families can do together. So, come out to the MPII Clubhouse parking lot that morning at 8 am and help us make our community beautiful! You can also RSVP to volunteer by emailing the EPC at epc@mpiicdd.org.

Later this month, ahead of Easter, will be the annual EPC Bunny Hop! This event will take place on Saturday, 3/28, from 10 am – 2 pm. Residents can get photos with the Easter Bunny, and there will be activities and refreshments!

The EPC has more events to come – including the always popular Summerfest! Look for future issues of *MPII News* for more details as they finalize plans!

Trivia Answer (from page 3): Maewyn Succat!

Maewyn Succat! He was born to a Roman British family in either Scotland or Wales. It is believed that he was captured by Irish pirates and sold into slavery in Ireland. While there he became religious. Many years later he returned to Ireland as a Bishop and helped spread Christianity in Ireland.

https://www.irishcentral.com/roots/history/st-patrick-real-name-maewyn-succat

MPII Clubs & Opportunities

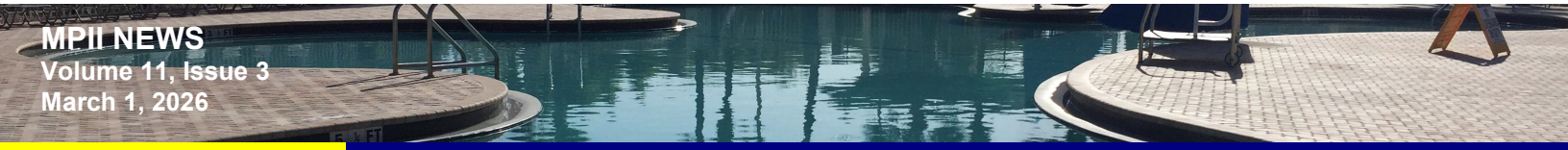


EC TENNIS ACADEMY offers tennis lessons to people aged 4 through adult. Contact Coach Edgardo Chavez at 813-328-0841.

TEACH LEAF is still enrolling for the 2025-2026 school year! The KLP, or Kindergarten Learning Pod, will meet on Mondays and Wednesdays at the MPII Clubhouse. This is a great opportunity for the children in our community! For more details or to enroll in the pod please contact Melissa Goebel at teacher.melissa827@gmail.com.

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MPII News Needs Your Photos!

If you have taken a photo within MPII that you think would make a nice cover shot on a future issue, please email it to newsletter@mpiicdd.org. Submitting a photo gives us permission to use it in the newsletter. If there are people in the photo, please ensure that we have their permission to publish their photo.

Also, remember that the Clubhouse has an opt-in email list for receiving the newsletter as a PDF each month! To opt-in, just email newsletter@mpiicdd.org and tell us what email address or addresses you'd like us to include. As of now, the Clubhouse only uses this list for the newsletter, but we may include other time-sensitive announcements in the future.